The Ultimate Grocery Unit Price & Dollar General Penny Shopping Cheat Sheet (2026 Edition)

Quick aisle math, realistic checkout totals, and coupon rules worth checking before you buy. Policies and offers can change; the live offer and register control.

1 Master Unit Price Conversion Matrix

Golden comparison rule: compare the same product type using one shared denominator. **Unit price = item price ÷ quantity in the chosen unit.** Package labels and shelf-unit conventions can differ; normalize the quantity yourself. [2]

WEIGHT

dry goods, meat, produce

1 pound (lb)	**16 oz = 453.592 g**
1 ounce (oz)	**28.35 g**
8 oz	**½ lb = 226.80 g**
16 oz	**1 lb = 453.59 g**
32 oz	**2 lb = 907.18 g**
1 kilogram (kg)	**≈ 2.2046 lb**

VOLUME

U.S. liquid measures

1 U.S. gallon (gal)	**4 qt = 128 fl oz**
1 gal	**≈ 3.785 L**
½ gal	**2 qt = 64 fl oz**
1 quart (qt)	**32 fl oz ≈ 946 mL**
1 pint (pt) / 1 cup	**16 / 8 fl oz**
1 U.S. fl oz	**≈ 29.57 mL**

NIST's customary-to-metric card factors are approximate; use exact factors when precision matters. [1]

COUNT & LOADS

dose matters

Laundry detergent	**price ÷ labeled loads**
Dishwasher pods	**price ÷ pod count**
Cost per cycle	**pod price × dose per cycle**

Compare labeled loads only when dose directions and performance claims match. If a wash needs 2 pods, count 2 pods as one cycle's dose.

PAPER GOODS

ignore "roll equivalents"

Total square feet	**sheets × L × W ÷ 144**
Unit price	**package price ÷ sq ft**

L and W are sheet dimensions in inches; 144 square inches = 1 square foot. Roll labels are not standardized. Use printed square footage, or sheet count *and* sheet size.

The 3-step register-to-rebate formula

STEP 1 · NORMALIZE

Get a fair baseline

Shelf unit price = shelf price ÷ normalized quantity

Convert first (for example, 2 lb = 32 oz). Compare like with like.

STEP 2 · PAY TODAY

Subtract instant savings

Register total = shelf price − instant discounts/coupons + tax/fees charged

Today's unit price = register total ÷ quantity. Use the actual post-coupon register total; tax treatment varies by location. [3]

STEP 3 · REBATE LATER

Keep expected and real separate

Estimated net = register total − expected rebate

Realized net = register total − rebate received

Divide either by quantity for a unit price. A rebate is not cash back until eligible and paid.

3 worked examples

Illustrative prices only · before tax/coupons

01 · Pasta: ounces vs. pounds

16 oz for $1.25 = **$1.25/lb**.
2 lb (32 oz) for $2.29 = $2.29 ÷ 2 = **$1.145/lb**.

2-lb pack wins on unit price.

02 · Juice: half-gallon vs. gallon

64 fl oz for $2.49 = ½ gal, or **$4.98/gal**.
1 gal for $3.99 = **$3.99/gal**.

Gallon is cheaper per gallon—if you'll use it.

03 · Paper towels: size beats roll count

$12: 6 × 110 sheets × 11×11 in = 554.6 sq ft; **2.16¢/sq ft**.
$12: 12 × 55 sheets × 11×10 in = 504.2 sq ft; **2.38¢/sq ft**.

The "mega" pack wins here; check sheet size.

PRO TIP Keep three prices in your notes: shelf unit price, after-instant-discount unit price, and after-rebate *realized* unit price. Rebate caps, qualifying items, deadlines, and tax rules vary; save the receipt and offer terms.

2 Dollar General Penny Shopping & Clearance Rules

Reality check: Dollar General does **not** publish a nationwide penny calendar, guaranteed 50% → 70% → 90% → $0.01 markdown ladder, fixed Tuesday schedule, or a rule requiring stores to sell a penny item. Its app describes scanning to search for coupons—not a guaranteed final-price lookup. Select the store and verify the exact item at checkout. [4] [5]

What deal communities report—not a promise

50% → 70% → 90% → $0.01

This pattern and seasonal clear-outs are reported shopper practice. Timing conflicts: one guide says Tuesday; another lists Wednesday, Nov. 4, 2026. Treat timing as a clue, not a schedule. [6] [7]

1. **Check the date and store.** Lists and markdown timing vary. Don't make a special trip based on an old list or weekday rumor.
2. **Scan the exact UPC.** Choose your store and scan the same size/flavor/package. The app scan is a coupon tool, not a penny-price or inventory guarantee; trust the register total.
3. **Search likely shelf areas.** Seasonal bays, clearance sections, endcaps, and regular aisles may all hold stragglers; layout varies by store.
4. **Be courteous to staff.** Don't ask employees to hunt for penny items or retrieve back-room stock. Accept a removal/refusal without arguing; there is no verified must-sell rule.
5. **Inspect before buying.** Check condition, date, safety notices, and the final register price. Never buy expired, damaged, or recalled goods just for the deal.

Visual clue checklist · hints only, never proof of a penny price

- ☐ Seasonal/holiday packaging after the season
- ☐ Older packaging beside a newer replacement
- ☐ Clearance sticker or markdown shelf
- ☐ Seasonal rack, endcap, or regular-aisle straggler

Tag colors are not standardized proof: sticker systems vary; only the current store/register price confirms what you'll pay.

3 Retailer Quick-Rules Summary

RETAILER	FAST RULE CHECK BEFORE CHECKOUT
CVS	Generally 1 manufacturer coupon per item; a manufacturer coupon may combine with a CVS coupon when eligible. ExtraBucks are redeemable on a later qualifying transaction—"rolling" is couponer shorthand, not a universal threshold rule. No official universal **98% spend rule**; check exclusions and the printed offer. [8] [9]
Walgreens	**Register Rewards** are one-use manufacturer/Catalina coupons and count toward the item-count rule. **Walgreens Cash** is an account reward: redemption tiers $1/$2/$3/$4/$5/$10/$20/$50; max $50 per transaction and $100/day. Thresholds and calculations are offer-specific; inspect terms. [10]
Target	Baseline per item: 1 manufacturer coupon + 1 Target category-level offer + 1 Target item-level offer, if terms allow. Activate Circle Bonuses. A Target Circle digital manufacturer coupon does **not** stack with a paper manufacturer coupon. Limits and exact offer terms control. [11]
Publix	Per item: 1 manufacturer coupon + either 1 Publix coupon *or* 1 nearby-competitor coupon (max 2). BOGO items count as separate purchases. A manufacturer BOGO coupon covers both required items; no extra manufacturer coupon. Competitor list is local—check your store. [12]

Always verify: exact product/size, qualifying spend, dates, activation, coupon limits, exclusions, channel, local tax, and whether the reward is instant or future value. Policies can change after this 2026 edition; an offer's live terms control.

SOURCE DESK · primary policy links first; penny-list sources are clearly secondary

[1] NIST, Unit Conversion / SP 811 — factors and conversion method.
[2] NIST, Uniform Unit Pricing — unit-price comparison.
[3] USAGov, State & Local Taxes — local tax variation.
[4] Dollar General App — barcode scans search coupons.
[5] DG Terms and Coupon Policy — limits/terms; no penny guarantee.
[6] The Krazy Coupon Lady, DG Penny List — reported patterns/tips, not DG policy.
[7] The Freebie Guy, Penny Shopping Guide — store/timing variation; secondary.
[8] CVS Coupon Policy — coupon combinations and limits.
[9] CVS ExtraCare Terms — ExtraBucks redemption and exclusions.
[10] Walgreens Coupon Policy and myWalgreens Terms.
[11] Target Coupon Policy and Target Circle Terms.
[12] Publix Coupon Policy and Coupon Stacking FAQ.